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Search Committee
Department of Economics
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
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Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in the Department of Economics at the University of Notre Dame. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Notre Dame's Department of Economics is distinguished by its commitment to rigorous research, evidence-based policy analysis, and a strong undergraduate and graduate program grounded in the university's Catholic mission of pursuing truth and promoting human flourishing. I see natural alignment between my work on wealth dynamics, inequality, and heterogeneous returns and the department's strengths in macroeconomics, applied microeconomics, public finance, and the study of economic mobility. I am especially drawn to the department's collaborative intellectual culture and its connections to interdisciplinary centers such as the Wilson Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities (LEO) and the Kellogg Institute, where empirical research informs policy and contributes to the greater social good.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for

classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students “convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Notre Dame, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows, clear economic intuition, and transparent data-driven analysis.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce rigorous, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate quantitative models that speak to macroeconomic and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) mentor students in an environment that values intellectual curiosity, analytical rigor, and service to the broader community. I am enthusiastic about the possibility of contributing to Notre Dame’s research, teaching, and service missions.

I would be honored to join the Department of Economics at the University of Notre Dame. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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